

▶▶▶

After you took over as MD & CEO, what was your thinking on how you wanted to drive change at the group?

We have to be very careful about what we change and what we don't. It's very easy for a new leader to come in and change things. We said that our purpose, 'Rise' [the group's articulated purpose is based on equality, sustainability and ethics] is timeless. We may contemporise it in terms of how we articulate it, but... our values are constant, they are not going to change. Our culture is a very good mix of being friendly and performance-oriented;

set a target to ensure that 90 per cent of new hires in leadership roles are from within the group. What is also going to change is a focus on diversity because having a diverse set of people and building an inclusive culture is good for business. In many ways, I look at myself as a custodian of our brand, of our values. We're taking into the future, things that have worked well for us in the past. This approach has been successful so far because we recognise the strength in what our leaders have built over time.

▶▶▶

What's the broader vision for the group? Are

to continue doing as we go forward. We've doubled profits in the past three years. But more important than profits, I think we've built on the strong foundation that we had in the past. So I think that Mahindra is living up to everything it stands for. I'd give a lot of credit to what we've inherited. For 17 years [from] 2002 to 2018, Mahindra was the best-performing stock in the Nifty and then we sort of had gone below for some time. But now we're back to being the best-performing stock. In terms of the vision for the group going forward, the first is to continue living our purpose. Second is to be a tech leader in every industry

financial discipline. The first year, we did a lot of that and therefore at the end of the first year, we pivoted to growth. Now we're going to really drive growth in our businesses by transforming our core which is auto, farm, Mahindra Finance and Tech Mahindra. Transforming the core was really about getting each of those businesses to be a successful leader in its space. And second, by creating growth gems—which we defined as companies with the potential and a plan to get to a market capitalisation of \$1 billion in three to five years.

When we think about the next three years, it's about how we deliver scale. We will deliver scale by capitalising on market leadership that we have in auto and farm, by unlocking the full potential of Mahindra Finance and Tech Mahindra, and achieving a 5x growth in our growth gems in five to seven years. We have set the bar higher as we believe we have the ability to do that.

If we can have our auto business deliver products that are outstanding, and we can get a huge demand for them, why can't we do that across all our businesses? Susten [a solar power producer], which was one of our growth gems, has a 5x growth plan already. Last Mile Mobility has a plan to grow 5x in two years. And both these businesses have external marquee investors who have

IF WE CONTINUE DELIVERING ON WHAT WE COMMITTED TO, INVESTORS WILL BE WILLING TO INVEST IN US. THE MINUTE WE STOP, EVERYBODY WILL START ASKING QUESTIONS

that is not going to change. What will change is financial discipline in how we drive our decisions and that also goes back to our core operating philosophy. We've had leaders in the past like Bharat Doshi [former Executive Director & Group CFO of M&M] who had very strong financial discipline and created value for us for many years. Our focus is going to be on talent and how we nurture leaders internally. We have

things looking good now that you've just crossed ₹10,000 crore in profits?

We're a purpose-driven company but along with our purpose, we've been able to create value for our shareholders as well. So it's a combination of being able to do both. I would also like to highlight that we made specific commitments over the past three years and we've exceeded every single one of them. And that's something that we want

that we are in and therefore to be future ready from that standpoint. And third, is to create value for our shareholders. So those are the three elements of what we call our strategic imperatives.

▶▶▶

What does it mean for your businesses?

When we look at our journey from three years ago, we started with a focus on capital allocation and